

Introduction to Data Provisioning

Data Provisioning is the process of collecting, integrating, transforming, and preparing data from multiple sources for analysis, reporting, and business intelligence applications.

It ensures that accurate and useful data is available to users when required.

Organizations generate large amounts of data from:

- Databases
- Websites
- Applications
- Cloud systems
- IoT devices

Raw data is often incomplete and inconsistent.

Data provisioning helps:

- Organize data
- Improve data quality
- Prepare data for analytics
- Support business decision-making

Objectives of Data Provisioning

1. Collect data from multiple sources
2. Improve data quality
3. Transform data into usable format
4. Provide accurate information
5. Support analytics and reporting

Data Provisioning Workflow

Data Sources



Extraction



Transformation



Loading



Data Warehouse



Visualization & Analytics

1. Data Warehouse

A Data Warehouse is a centralized repository that stores integrated historical data from multiple sources for reporting and analysis.

A data warehouse supports:

- Business Intelligence
- Analytics
- Reporting
- Decision support systems

It stores cleaned and structured data.

Characteristics of Data Warehouse

1. Subject-oriented
2. Integrated
3. Time-variant

Advantages

1. Centralized data storage.
2. Better business analysis.

Disadvantages

1. High implementation cost.
2. Complex maintenance.

Applications

- Banking systems

2. Schemas in Data Warehouse

A Schema is the logical structure that defines how data is organized in a data warehouse.

Types of Schemas

1. Star Schema
2. Snowflake Schema
3. Fact Constellation Schema

A. Star Schema

A Star Schema contains one central fact table connected to multiple dimension tables.

Structure

Dimension Tables



Fact Table



Dimension Tables

Advantages

1. Simple design.
2. Faster query execution.

Disadvantages

1. Data redundancy.

B. Snowflake Schema

Snowflake Schema is an extension of star schema where dimension tables are normalized.

Advantages

1. Reduced redundancy.
2. Better data organization.

Disadvantages

1. Complex queries.

C. Fact Constellation Schema

Uses multiple fact tables connected to shared dimension tables.

Applications

- Complex enterprise systems

3. Data Quality

Data Quality refers to the accuracy, completeness, consistency, and reliability of data.

Poor quality data leads to:

- Incorrect analysis
- Wrong decisions
- Business losses

Characteristics of Data Quality

1. Accuracy
2. Completeness
3. Consistency
4. Validity
5. Timeliness

Advantages

1. Better decision-making.
2. Improved analytics accuracy.

Challenges

1. Missing data.
2. Duplicate records.
3. Inconsistent formats.

4. Data Profiling

Data Profiling is the process of analyzing data to understand its structure, quality, and content.

Objectives

- Identify missing values
- Detect duplicates
- Analyze patterns
- Check consistency

Types of Data Profiling

A. Structure Profiling

Analyzes data format

B. Content Profiling

Checks actual values.

C. Relationship Profiling

Analyzes relationships between datasets.

Advantages

1. Improves data quality.
2. Detects anomalies.
3. Helps preprocessing.

Applications

- Data cleaning
- ETL systems
- Data migration

5. Data Enrichment

Data Enrichment is the process of enhancing existing data by adding additional useful information. Raw data may not contain sufficient details. Additional information improves analysis quality.

Example

Adding customer demographic information to sales data.

Advantages

1. Better insights.

2. Improved analytics.
3. More accurate predictions.

Disadvantages

1. Increased storage requirements.
2. Additional processing cost.

Applications

- Marketing analytics
- Customer segmentation

6. Data Duplication

Data Duplication occurs when identical or repeated data records exist in multiple locations.

Causes

- Multiple data sources
- Improper integration
- System synchronization errors

Problems of Data Duplication

1. Increased storage usage
2. Inconsistent data
3. Reduced processing efficiency

Duplicate Detection Techniques

- Data matching
- Hashing
- AI-based duplicate detection

Advantages of Removing Duplicates

1. Better data quality.
2. Reduced storage cost.
3. Improved analytics accuracy.

7. ETL Architecture

ETL Architecture defines the framework used for Extracting, Transforming, and Loading data into a data warehouse.

ETL Full Form

ETL = Extract → Transform → Load

ETL Architecture Workflow

Data Sources



Extraction Layer



Transformation Layer



Loading Layer



Data Warehouse

Components of ETL Architecture

- 1. Source Layer** - Collects raw data.
- 2. Staging Area** - Temporary storage for processing.
- 3. Transformation Layer** - Cleans and converts data.
- 4. Target Layer** - Stores processed data.

Advantages

1. Structured data integration.
2. Better analytics support.

Disadvantages

1. Complex implementation.
2. Time-consuming processing.

8. What is ETL?

ETL is the process of extracting data from sources, transforming it into suitable format, and loading it into a target system.

ETL Steps

- A. Extraction** - Collect data from multiple sources.
- B. Transformation** - Clean and process data.
- C. Loading** - Store transformed data into warehouse.

Advantages

1. Integrates multiple datasets.
2. Improves data quality.

Applications

- Data warehousing
- Business analytics
- Reporting systems

9. Extraction Concept

Extraction is the process of retrieving data from various data sources for further processing.

Types of Extraction

A. Full Extraction

Entire dataset extracted.

B. Incremental Extraction

Only changed data extracted.

Advantages

1. Data integration support.
2. Faster analytics preparation.

Applications

- ETL systems
- Data migration

10. Change Data Capture (CDC)

Change Data Capture (CDC) is a technique used to identify and capture changes made to database records.

CDC detects:

- Insertions
- Updates
- Deletions

without processing the entire dataset.

Working

Database Changes

↓

Capture Modified Records

↓

Update Data Warehouse

Advantages

1. Faster data synchronization.
2. Reduced processing overhead.
3. Supports real-time analytics.

Disadvantages

1. Complex implementation.
2. Additional monitoring required.

Applications

- Real-time BI
- Database replication
- Streaming systems

1. Transformation Concept

Transformation is the process of converting raw extracted data into a clean, structured, and suitable format before loading it into a data warehouse.

Data collected from different sources may contain:

- Missing values
- Duplicate records
- Different formats
- Errors and inconsistencies

Transformation improves data quality and prepares data for analytics.

Transformation Operations

A. Data Cleaning - Removes errors and duplicate records.

B. Data Filtering - Selects required data only.

C. Data Aggregation - Combines multiple records into summarized form.

D. Data Normalization - Converts data into a standard format.

E. Data Conversion - Changes data types or formats.

Example

Date Format: 12/05/2026 → 2026-05-12

Advantages

1. Improves data quality.
2. Increases consistency.

Disadvantages

1. Time-consuming process.
2. Complex for large datasets.

Applications

- Data warehousing
- Business analytics

2. Lookups

Lookup is a transformation technique used to retrieve related information from another table or dataset during ETL processing. Lookups help combine and enrich data using reference tables.

Working

Step 1: Input data received.

Step 2: Lookup table searched.

Step 3: Matching value retrieved.

Example

Employee table retrieves department name using department ID.

Types of Lookups

A. Connected Lookup

Connected directly to ETL pipeline.

B. Unconnected Lookup

Called only when required.

Advantages

1. Improves data enrichment.
2. Reduces redundancy.
3. Supports data integration.

Disadvantages

1. Slower for large datasets.

Applications

- ETL processing
- Data integration

3. Time Lag

Time Lag is the delay between data generation and data availability in the target system or data warehouse.

Causes of Time Lag

- Network delays
- Large data processing
- Batch processing
- Slow ETL execution

Example: Sales data generated at 10 AM reaches warehouse at 11 AM.

Effects of Time Lag

1. Delayed analytics
2. Outdated reports
3. Slower decision-making

Methods to Reduce Time Lag

- Real-time ETL
- Incremental loading
- Faster processing systems

Advantages of Reducing Time Lag

1. Faster reporting.
2. Real-time analytics.
3. Better business decisions.

4. Formats

Formats define the structure and representation of data in databases and ETL systems.

Common Data Formats

Format Description

CSV	Comma-separated values
JSON	JavaScript Object Notation
XML	Extensible Markup Language
Parquet	Column-based storage format
Excel	Spreadsheet format

Importance of Formats

1. Ensures compatibility.
2. Simplifies data exchange.
3. Improves processing efficiency.

Challenges

1. Format incompatibility.
2. Data conversion complexity.

Applications

- Data integration
- Cloud systems
- Distributed analytics

5. Consistency

Consistency means maintaining accurate and uniform data across all systems and databases.

Inconsistent data causes:

- Incorrect reports
- Duplicate information

- Wrong decisions

Example

Customer name stored differently in two systems.

Types of Consistency

A. Data Consistency - Same data values across systems.

B. Transaction Consistency - Correct execution of transactions.

Methods to Maintain Consistency

1. Data validation
2. Synchronization
3. Duplicate removal

Advantages

1. Accurate analytics.
2. Reliable reporting.

6. Loading Concept

Loading is the process of storing transformed data into the target data warehouse or database. It is the final step of the ETL process.

Loading Workflow

Extract Data
↓
Transform Data
↓
Load into Warehouse

Types of Loading

1. Initial Loading
2. Incremental Loading

Advantages

1. Centralized storage.
2. Supports reporting and analytics.

7. Initial Loading

Initial Loading loads the complete dataset into the target system for the first time.

Features

- Full dataset transferred
- Performed once initially

Advantages

1. Complete data availability.
2. Simple implementation.

Disadvantages

1. Time-consuming.
2. High resource usage.

Applications

- New data warehouse setup
- Data migration

8. Incremental Loading

Incremental Loading transfers only newly added or modified records instead of loading the entire dataset again. Used after initial loading to improve efficiency.

Working

Detect Changed Data
↓
Load Only Modified Records

Advantages

1. Faster processing.
2. Reduced storage usage.
3. Efficient updates.

Disadvantages

1. Complex change tracking.

Applications

- Real-time BI systems
- Streaming analytics

Conclusion

Incremental loading improves ETL efficiency by processing only changed data.

9. Late Arriving Facts

Late Arriving Facts are data records that arrive after the expected processing time.

Sometimes data is delayed because of:

- Network failures
- System delays
- Processing errors

Example

Sales transaction occurs today but reaches warehouse tomorrow.

Problems Caused

1. Incorrect reports.
2. Delayed analytics.
3. Inconsistent data.

Handling Techniques

- Data reprocessing
- Timestamp management
- Incremental updates

Advantages of Proper Handling

1. Accurate reporting.
2. Improved consistency.

10. What is Staging?

Staging is a temporary storage area used in ETL systems before data is transformed and loaded into the warehouse.

Raw extracted data is stored in staging area for:

- Cleaning
- Validation
- Transformation

Workflow

Source Data
↓
Staging Area
↓
Transformation
↓
Data Warehouse

Advantages

1. Improves ETL management.
2. Supports error handling.
3. Simplifies transformation.

Disadvantages

1. Requires additional storage.

Applications

- ETL systems
- Data migration

11. Data Marts

A Data Mart is a smaller, department-specific subset of a data warehouse. Data marts focus on a particular business function such as:

- Sales
- Finance
- Marketing

Types of Data Marts

1. Dependent Data Mart
2. Independent Data Mart
3. Hybrid Data Mart

Advantages

1. Faster access to departmental data.
2. Reduced complexity.
3. Better performance.

Disadvantages

1. Limited scope.
2. Data duplication risk.

Applications

- Sales analysis
- HR reporting
- Inventory management

12. Cubes

A Data Cube is a multidimensional data structure used for fast analytical processing in Business Intelligence systems.

Data cubes organize data across multiple dimensions.

Example Dimensions

- Time
- Product
- Location

Cube Structure

Time
↑
Product ← Cube → Location

Operations on Cubes

1. Slice
2. Dice
3. Drill-down
4. Roll-up

Advantages

1. Fast analytical queries.
2. Multidimensional analysis.
3. Better reporting.

Disadvantages

1. Large storage requirement.
2. Complex maintenance.

Applications

- OLAP systems
- Sales analytics
- Business dashboards

Introduction to Data Visualization

Data Visualization is the graphical representation of data and information using charts, graphs, dashboards, and visual elements to make analysis easier and more understandable. Organizations generate huge amounts of business data daily.

Raw data is difficult to understand directly.

Visualization helps:

- Identify patterns
- Compare performance
- Detect trends
- Support business decisions

Objectives of Data Visualization

1. Simplify complex data
2. Improve understanding
3. Support decision-making
4. Detect trends and anomalies

5. Enhance reporting efficiency

Data Visualization Workflow

Raw Data
↓
Processing
↓
Visualization
↓
Insights
↓
Decision Making

1. What is a Business Report?

A Business Report is a structured document that presents business data, analysis, insights, and recommendations for decision-making.

Business reports help organizations monitor:

- Sales
- Finance
- Customer behavior
- Inventory
- Employee performance

Reports are generated using BI tools and analytics systems.

Features of Business Reports

1. Organized information
2. Visual representation
3. Performance analysis
4. Decision support

Types of Business Reports

Type	Purpose
Operational Report	Daily operations monitoring
Financial Report	Financial analysis
Analytical Report	Data analysis and trends
Performance Report	KPI monitoring

Advantages

1. Better decision-making.
2. Improved communication.

3. Easy performance monitoring.

Disadvantages

1. Time-consuming preparation.
2. Data accuracy dependency.

Applications

- Sales management
- Financial planning
- Inventory tracking

2. Components of Business Reporting Systems

Business Reporting Systems are systems that collect, process, analyze, and present business information.

Main Components

A. Data Sources

Collect raw business data from databases, applications, and external systems.

B. Data Warehouse

Stores integrated historical data.

C. ETL Process

Extracts, transforms, and loads data.

D. Analytics Engine

Processes data and generates insights.

E. Reporting Tools

Generate charts, dashboards, and reports.

F. Visualization Layer

Displays information graphically.

Architecture

Data Sources



ETL Process



Data Warehouse



Analytics Engine



Reports & Dashboards

Advantages

1. Centralized reporting.
2. Faster business analysis.

3. Improved monitoring.

Applications

- Enterprise reporting
- Financial analytics
- KPI monitoring

3. Data and Information Visualization

Data Visualization represents raw data graphically, while Information Visualization presents processed information and insights visually.

Difference Between Data and Information Visualization

Parameter	Data Visualization	Information Visualization
Focus	Raw data	Processed insights
Purpose	Data representation	Knowledge presentation
Example	Sales chart	Business performance dashboard

Importance

1. Simplifies analysis.
2. Enhances understanding.
3. Improves communication.

Applications

- Business dashboards
- Scientific analysis
- Financial reporting

4. Types of Charts and Graphs

Charts and graphs are visual tools used to represent data.

A. Bar Chart

Represents data using rectangular bars.

Applications

- Comparing sales
- Product analysis

B. Line Graph

Represents data trends over time using lines.

Applications

- Stock market trends
- Sales growth analysis

C. Pie Chart

Represents data as portions of a circle.

Applications

- Market share analysis
- Budget distribution

D. Histogram

Shows frequency distribution of data.

Applications

- Statistical analysis
- Data distribution analysis

E. Scatter Plot

Displays relationships between two variables.

Applications

- Correlation analysis
- Machine learning

F. Area Chart

Represents quantitative data with filled areas.

Applications

- Trend analysis
- Performance comparison

Advantages of Charts and Graphs

1. Easy understanding.
2. Faster comparison.
3. Better pattern detection.

Disadvantages

1. Oversimplification possible.
2. Wrong chart selection may confuse users.

5. Visual Analytics

Visual Analytics combines data visualization, analytics, and interactive exploration to analyze large datasets.

Visual analytics helps users:

- Explore patterns
- Detect anomalies
- Analyze trends
- Make faster decisions

Components of Visual Analytics

1. Data processing
2. Visualization tools
3. Interactive analysis
4. AI and analytics

Advantages

1. Faster insights.
2. Interactive exploration.
3. Better decision-making.

Disadvantages

1. High computational requirements.
2. Complex implementation.

Applications

- Big data analytics
- Financial analysis
- Healthcare analytics

6. Performance Dashboards

A Performance Dashboard is a visual interface that displays important business metrics and KPIs in real time.

Dashboards summarize business performance using:

- Charts
- Graphs
- Indicators
- Tables

Types of Dashboards

A. Operational Dashboard

Monitors daily operations.

B. Strategic Dashboard

Supports long-term planning.

C. Analytical Dashboard

Provides detailed analytical insights.

Dashboard Components

1. KPIs
2. Charts and graphs
3. Alerts and notifications
4. Reports

Advantages

1. Real-time monitoring.
2. Improved decision-making.
3. Better performance tracking.

Disadvantages

1. Complex design.
2. Information overload possible.

Applications

- Sales monitoring
- Financial tracking
- Supply chain management

7. Business Performance Management (BPM)

Business Performance Management is the process of monitoring, analyzing, and improving organizational performance using BI tools and analytics.

Objectives of BPM

1. Improve efficiency
2. Track business goals
3. Optimize performance
4. Support strategic planning

BPM Process

Business Goals



Data Collection



Performance Analysis



Decision Making



Performance Improvement

Components of BPM

1. KPI monitoring

2. Reporting systems
3. Forecasting
4. Performance dashboards
5. Analytics

Advantages

1. Better business control.
2. Improved productivity.
3. Goal tracking.

Disadvantages

1. Expensive implementation.
2. Requires quality data.

Applications

- Enterprise management
- Financial planning
- Production management

Introduction to BI Tools

Business Intelligence (BI) Tools are software applications used to collect, process, analyze, visualize, and report business data for decision-making.

Organizations generate huge volumes of data daily.

BI tools help users:

- Analyze business data
- Create dashboards
- Generate reports
- Visualize trends

These tools simplify complex data analysis using charts, graphs, and interactive dashboards.

Objectives of BI Tools

1. Simplify data analysis
2. Generate business reports
3. Support data visualization
4. Improve decision-making
5. Enable real-time monitoring

Common Features of BI Tools

1. Data connectivity

2. Dashboard creation
3. Interactive visualization
4. Reporting and analytics
5. Data sharing and collaboration

BI Tool Architecture

Data Sources



BI Tool



Analytics & Visualization



Reports and Dashboards



Decision Making

1. Tableau

Developed by: [Tableau](#)

Tableau is a powerful data visualization and analytics tool used for creating interactive dashboards and reports.

Tableau helps users analyze large datasets visually without extensive programming knowledge.

It supports:

- Drag-and-drop interface
- Real-time analytics
- Interactive dashboards

Features of Tableau

1. Interactive dashboards
2. Real-time data analysis
3. Drag-and-drop visualization
4. Data blending and integration

Advantages

1. Easy to use.
2. Excellent visualization capabilities.

Disadvantages

1. Expensive licensing.
2. Limited data preprocessing.

Applications

- Sales analytics

- Financial analysis
- Marketing analytics
- Business reporting

2. Power BI

Developed by: [Microsoft Power BI](#)

Power BI is a Business Intelligence and analytics tool developed by Microsoft for data visualization, reporting, and business analytics.

Power BI integrates easily with Microsoft products and cloud services.

It supports:

- Real-time dashboards
- AI-powered analytics
- Data sharing

Components of Power BI

1. Power BI Desktop
2. Power BI Service
3. Power BI Mobile

Features

1. Interactive dashboards
2. Cloud integration
3. AI-based insights
4. Real-time monitoring
5. Data connectivity

Advantages

1. Easy Microsoft integration.
2. Affordable pricing.
3. User-friendly interface.

Disadvantages

1. Limited customization compared to Tableau.

Applications

- Enterprise analytics
- KPI monitoring
- Business reporting

3. Dundas BI

Developed by: [Dundas BI](#)

Dundas BI is a Business Intelligence platform used for reporting, dashboard creation, and data visualization.

Dundas BI provides flexible and customizable analytics solutions.

Features

1. Interactive dashboards
2. Advanced charting
3. Data integration
4. Custom analytics

Advantages

1. Highly customizable.
2. Strong dashboard features.

Disadvantages

1. Complex for beginners.
2. Higher implementation cost.

Applications

- Enterprise reporting
- Financial dashboards
- Data analytics

4. Oracle BI

Developed by: [Oracle Business Intelligence](#)

Oracle BI is an enterprise Business Intelligence platform used for analytics, reporting, and performance management.

Oracle BI supports large-scale enterprise analytics and integrates with Oracle databases and cloud systems.

Features

1. Enterprise reporting
2. Real-time analytics
3. KPI dashboards
4. Predictive analytics
5. Strong database integration

Advantages

1. Highly scalable.
2. Strong enterprise support.

3. Advanced analytics features.

Disadvantages

1. Expensive.
2. Complex implementation.

Applications

- Enterprise management
- Financial analytics
- Supply chain management

5. MS Excel

Developed by: [Microsoft Excel](#)

MS Excel is a spreadsheet application used for data analysis, calculations, visualization, and reporting.

Excel is one of the most commonly used BI tools for small and medium-scale analytics.

Features

1. Spreadsheet calculations
2. Charts and graphs
3. Pivot tables
4. Data filtering and sorting
5. Basic analytics

Advantages

1. Easy to use.
2. Widely available.
3. Good for small datasets.

Disadvantages

1. Limited scalability.
2. Less efficient for very large datasets.

Applications

- Financial analysis
- Data reporting
- Inventory tracking
- Statistical analysis

Comparison of BI Tools

Tool	Main Strength	Best Use
Tableau	Advanced visualization	Interactive dashboards
Power BI	Microsoft integration	Enterprise analytics
Dundas BI	Custom dashboards	Enterprise reporting
Oracle BI	Large-scale analytics	Enterprise management
MS Excel	Simplicity	Small-scale analysis

Advantages of BI Tools

1. Faster data analysis
2. Better decision-making
3. Real-time reporting
4. Interactive visualization
5. Improved business efficiency

Challenges of BI Tools

1. High implementation cost
2. Data security concerns
3. Large-scale data complexity
4. Training requirements